

art meditations on

LIVING SPACE



www.maisonevieve.com

Prelude

I'm Evi Michailidou and I am an artist and yoga instructor.

Before we begin, close the door behind you. Let your shoulders drop. Loosen your jaw. Take three unhurried breaths.

Inhale — through the nose.
Exhale — through the mouth.
Allow the breath to fall into its own rhythm.

You are stepping into a slower moment. This is not a lesson or a performance. It is a homecoming. Everything here is meant to bring you back to yourself — gently, like light spilling through sheer curtains in the morning.

Thank you for giving my art space on your wall, now let it fill your mind too, so there won't be too much more space for overthinking or worrying.

With love,
Evi
for Maison Evienne



I. Inner Child

Find a comfortable seat. Let your body be supported by whatever holds you — chair, floor, cushions. Notice the weight of your body resting.

Now, let your imagination carry you away, as softly as a dream. You are walking down a quiet street. The ground is slightly wet, the scent of rain mingling with roasted coffee and something faintly floral — perhaps lilac from a nearby window box.

You hear laughter echo from a distance, a piano playing somewhere unseen. And then you notice a small hand slipping into yours.

Your inner child is here — curious-eyed, perhaps shy, but utterly present. They are exactly the age you most needed tenderness. Look at them. What do they wear? What is their expression when they see you? Do they recognize you? Do they trust you?

Together you wander until you find a small bookstore tucked behind an ivy covered façade. The air inside is warm and smells of dust, paper, and quiet devotion.

Run your fingers along the spines of the books. Each one feels like a heartbeat from another century. Your child's eyes widen — joy, wonder, belonging. For a moment, you feel both of you breathing in sync. Stay in this shared stillness.

Now imagine the day fading. You return to a small attic room, its window overlooking the city. The rooftops shimmer in the last light.

You help your inner child into bed. Before sleep takes them, whisper gently: “What do you need from me?” Wait for the answer. It might come as words, an image, a sound, or a simple feeling in your chest. Whatever it is, receive it without trying to fix or explain.

Then say: “You are safe. You are heard. I’m here.”

Stay with that warmth a little longer, until it settles like a soft weight in your body.

II. Ritual of Yellow

Yellow — the color of sunlight and laughter, of awakening and joy remembered. It's not loud happiness. It's the kind that glows quietly from within. This ritual honors the light that remains in you, no matter how many seasons have passed. We'll create a small ceremonial space around this color.

Setting the Scene

Choose a time of day when you can be undisturbed for at least half an hour. Dim harsh lights. If it's daytime, let natural light fill the space. Place your two art prints nearby, within your sightline.

Now gather a few simple elements — nothing extravagant, just symbolic: A yellow flower or cloth. A small glass of lemonade or warm tea. A scent that feels alive: citrus, verbena, neroli, or a blend of lemon, orange, and nutmeg. A piece of music that gently lifts your mood. This is your altar of joy — a simple table for beauty, play, and remembrance.

Touch

Pick up something smooth and bright — the flower's petal, a silk ribbon, even a balloon if you like its silly charm.

Let your fingertips explore its texture.

Notice the small sparks of pleasure that rise from contact.

Touch brings us back into the present.

We remember that joy is a physical thing.

Scent

Spray or diffuse your chosen scent. Inhale deeply. Notice where the fragrance lands — the chest, the throat, the temples. Imagine it clearing old dust from your mind.

Vision

Look at the prints before you. Their shapes are abstract, yet something within them feels familiar. You don't need to *understand* — only to feel. Watch how the colors change with the light, how shadows play over the surface. Let your gaze soften, as if looking through water.

Taste

Take a sip of your drink. Close your eyes while swallowing. Let the taste awaken your tongue — sharp, sweet, vivid. Notice how something so simple can feel sacred when given full attention.

Sound

Play your music softly, or listen to the sounds around you — the hum of the room, your breath, distant life. Every sound becomes part of the atmosphere.

When all senses are alive, you are not escaping reality — you are inhabiting it.

Art Print Care

Giclée prints are known for their exceptional quality and vivid colors, and when printed on premium Hahnemühle Bamboo Paper, they offer a unique, environmentally conscious choice for art lovers. This paper is made from 90% bamboo fibers, giving it an interesting texture and natural aesthetic, perfect for enhancing the textures of these paintings. Proper care will ensure that your giclée print remains vibrant and beautiful for years to come.

1. Framing and Display

- **Use UV-Protective Glass or Acrylic:** To protect the print from fading due to light exposure, frame your artwork under UV-protective glass or acrylic. This will help preserve the vivid colors of your giclée print for many years.
- **Matting:** Always use a mat between the artwork and the glass to prevent it from coming into direct contact with the frame's surface. A mat will also allow air to circulate around the print, minimizing moisture buildup.
- **Avoid Cheap Frames:** Invest in a high-quality, archival frame. Cheap frames can cause damage over time, especially to the edges of the paper or the ink. Look for frames made with acid-free materials to ensure the longevity of your giclée print.

2. Storage

- **Flat Storage:** Store your print flat, rather than rolled, to avoid creases or bends. Keep the print in a safe, dry place with minimal exposure to light and fluctuating temperatures.

- **Protective Sleeves:** When storing prints, use acid-free, archival-quality protective sleeves or portfolios. These will safeguard the print from dust, dirt, and physical damage.
- **Avoid Extreme Temperatures:** Never store your print in areas with extreme temperatures or humidity, such as attics or basements. Exposure to high humidity can cause the paper to warp or the ink to fade.

3. Handling

- **Clean Hands:** Always handle your print with clean hands to avoid transferring oils or dirt onto the surface. If possible, wear cotton gloves to protect the print.
- **Avoid Direct Contact with the Image:** Try not to touch the printed surface. Oils and dirt from your fingers can leave marks or smudges, affecting the print's appearance. If handling is necessary, touch only the edges or use gloves.
- **Support the Print:** If you need to move or reposition the print, always hold it by the edges or, better yet, support it with both hands from underneath to prevent any unnecessary bending or stress.

4. Cleaning and Dusting

- **Use a Soft Brush:** Use a soft, clean brush (such as a sable or synthetic brush) to gently sweep off any dust. Brush lightly in a circular motion to avoid damaging the print's surface.
- **Compressed Air:** You can also use compressed air to remove dust. Be sure to hold the can upright and at a slight distance from the print to avoid damaging the print or blowing dust further into the surface.
- **Avoid Wiping:** Do not wipe or rub the surface of your print. Using a cloth or abrasive cleaning materials can scratch or smudge the surface, damaging the print permanently.

5. Lighting

- **Avoid Direct Sunlight:** Never expose your print to direct sunlight for prolonged periods, as this can cause the colors to fade and the paper to weaken.
- **Use Soft Lighting:** Display your print under soft, diffused light. Low-UV lighting is ideal for preserving the integrity of your artwork.
- **LED Lights:** Use LED lights with low UV emissions to display your print. These lights emit minimal heat and are a safe option for preserving your print's vibrancy.

6. Humidity Control

- **Maintain Stable Humidity:** Keep the environment where the print is stored or displayed at a consistent humidity level (ideally between 40-60%). Excess moisture can cause the paper to warp or the ink to bleed.
- **Avoid Moisture:** Do not hang or store the print in areas prone to humidity, such as bathrooms, kitchens, or near windows where rain or condensation can affect the artwork.

7. Long-Term Care

- **Rotate Displays:** If possible, rotate prints in frames occasionally to reduce prolonged exposure to light.
- **Protect from Pollutants:** Keep the print away from dust, smoke, or pollutants, which can damage the paper and ink over time.
- **Keep it in a Controlled Environment:** The best place for your giclée print is a stable, controlled indoor environment, away from extreme temperature changes, direct sunlight, or sources of humidity.

III. The Living Space

Our homes mirror our inner states.
What surrounds you either clutters or clears your mind.

Take a slow look around.
What catches your attention first?
What feels restful? What feels restless?

Without judgment, notice how your environment affects your breathing.

You might choose to rearrange a corner, dust a forgotten shelf, or light a candle.
Even a single gesture — folding a blanket, placing a flower in a jar — shifts energy.

Let your space become a partner in your ritual life, not a backdrop.

Over time, choose your art, your scents, your textures as you'd choose words in a poem.
Nothing superfluous — only what stirs something essential.

When your surroundings begin to echo your inner rhythm, you'll notice it:
The mind quiets.
Time stretches.
Beauty returns to its rightful place — not as luxury, but as necessity.

IV. The Art Meditation

Now sit in front of your two prints.

Let the eyes wander slowly — from form to color, from emptiness to movement.

Ask yourself quietly: What emotion stirs when I look at this? What memory, what sensation? Don't analyze. Just observe.

Now, bring awareness to your breath again. With each inhale, imagine drawing the artwork into yourself — its shapes, its light, its mystery. With each exhale, imagine offering something back — understanding, feeling, gratitude. You and the artwork are in quiet dialogue. Pause here.

Now look at the reference images — the “real” forms from which these abstractions were born.

See how familiarity shifts perception.

This is how memory works: time deconstructs the literal until only essence remains.

Return to the artwork now.

See it anew.

Notice what it reveals only after being “decoded.”

Let this remind you that truth is often not in what we see, but in what stays with us after the image fades.



V. Happy Place

We all need escape — but not away from life, rather into its gentlest corners. Visualization is a doorway back to ease. Find a comfortable position again. Close your eyes.

Picture a place where your mind feels rested and your heart unguarded. It may be real — a beach, a childhood garden, a Parisian café — or imagined entirely.

Notice what the air feels like there. Is it warm? Crisp? What sounds fill the space — wind, laughter, music, silence? What colors live there? Include textures, colors, objects, words that evoke the feeling, as you build up the space in your mind.

Linger long enough for this imagined space to feel inhabited. You can return here any time.

Over time, your happy place may shift — that's natural. What matters is not the location, but the sensation of belonging to yourself.

When you return from this inner landscape, pause before moving. Notice how the body feels softer, the mind clearer. Carry that feeling like perfume on your skin.

Your happy place is not a fantasy — it is a frequency. You can tune into it at will.



Practice Tracker

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WHAT I LIKED ABOUT THIS PRACTICE:

WHAT I WILL CHANGE FOR NEXT TIME:

VI. Closing

Art and ritual are not separate languages.
Both are ways of remembering what is
sacred in the ordinary.

These pieces — and this guide — are meant
to live with you. Hang the prints where
your eyes can meet them daily. Let them
remind you to slow down, to listen inward,
to notice the poetry in silence.

You are not simply looking at art. You are
participating in it.

Every time you breathe with awareness,
every time you create beauty deliberately,
you are practicing slow living art — the true
spirit of Maison Evève.

May these pieces hold you, the way sunlight
holds dust in the air — weightless, timeless,
quietly alive.

Love,
Evi
for Maison Evève



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